



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*dīptikṛttaśirāḥ so 'tha duḥkhenosreṇa cārditaḥ |
papāta mūḍhacetā vai yogadharmavivarjitaḥ || 44 ||
tataḥ suptotthita iva saṃjñāṃ labdhvā mahātapāḥ |
maṇḍalasthaṃ mahādevamastauśiddhīnāyā girā || 45 ||
namaḥ sahasranetrāya śatanetrāya vai namaḥ |
namo vivṛtavaktrāya śatavaktrāya vai namaḥ || 46 ||*

— Skandapurāṇa, Chapter 5, Verses 44-46

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

A being, overcome by intense suffering and described as devoid of yogic principles, falls, his "head cut off by radiance." While this sounds literal, consider it a symbolic representation of ego dissolution. The "radiance" isn't a physical weapon, but the blinding light of truth, severing the head representing pride and ignorance. He falls because he lacks the grounding of spiritual practice, "yogadharmavivarjitaḥ," leaving him vulnerable to life's trials.

Then, like someone awakened from deep slumber, awareness dawns. He regains consciousness, "suptotthita iva saṃjñāṃ labdhvā," signifying a spiritual reawakening. This is crucial: even in our darkest moments, the potential for transformation remains. Overwhelmed with remorse, he begins to praise Mahadeva, Shiva, the great God, who is visualized in the center of a mandala. His hymn is filled with humility, "dīnāyā girā," a sign of sincere repentance. He acknowledges Shiva as the one with a thousand eyes and a hundred eyes, representing infinite awareness and all-seeing perception. He praises the God with a hundred mouths, signifying the endless expressions and manifestations of the divine.

What can you glean from this ancient story for your own life? When you are struck by hardship, remember that it might be an opportunity for your ego to be humbled. Do not resist the fall, but embrace the potential for awakening. Like the being in the story, turn to the divine, however you understand it, with humility and sincerity. Recognize the divine presence in all things, the "thousand eyes" and "hundred mouths" expressing themselves in the world around you. Through prayer, meditation, or simply mindful awareness, you can cultivate the yogic principles that will ground you in times of turbulence, preventing the painful fall. The essence of the story is that even after falling from grace, spiritual growth is possible through humility and devotion.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What "radiance" in your life might be trying to "cut off" your pride, and are you resisting the lesson it offers?